



Addition and subtraction

Addition and subtraction are essential operations in mathematics and daily life. They are used when checking change, calculating distance or finding how many items remain. Fluency in mental and written methods helps pupils calculate accurately and independently.

$$+ \quad 124 + 8 = 132$$

Combine to find a total

$$- \quad 350 - 40 = 310$$

Find what remains or the difference

Why these operations matter

They support almost every other area of mathematics. Multiplication develops from repeated addition, division can involve repeated subtraction, and money, measurement and data all depend on reliable calculation.

MULTIPLICATION

repeated addition

MONEY & MEASURE

totals and differences

DATA

compare quantities

Mental maths in everyday life

Year 3 pupils add and subtract ones, tens and hundreds mentally from three-digit numbers. They use place value and known number facts instead of counting every step.

ONES

$$324 + 7 = 331$$

Bridge through 330: +6, then +1

TENS

$$350 - 40 = 310$$

Subtract four tens

HUNDREDS

$$426 + 200 = 626$$

Add two hundreds

MENTAL STRATEGY

Partition numbers, use known facts and bridge through a multiple of 10 when helpful.



Written methods and checking

Columnar methods for greater accuracy

When calculations become more complex, align ones, tens and hundreds in their correct columns. Work from right to left and regroup when necessary. A clear layout reduces place-value errors.

COLUMN ADDITION

$$\begin{array}{r}
 236 \\
 + 147 \\
 \hline
 383
 \end{array}$$

$6 + 7 = 13$
 Write 3; regroup 1 ten
 $3 + 4 + 1 = 8$ tens
 $2 + 1 = 3$ hundreds

COLUMN SUBTRACTION

$$\begin{array}{r}
 452 \\
 - 178 \\
 \hline
 274
 \end{array}$$

Regroup before subtracting
 $12 - 8 = 4$ ones
 $14 - 7 = 7$ tens
 $3 - 1 = 2$ hundreds

Estimate first, check afterwards

Estimating gives an expected range before calculating. Afterwards, use the inverse operation: subtraction checks addition, and addition checks subtraction.

ESTIMATE

$$240 + 150 \approx 390 \quad \text{Exact answer: } 383$$

INVERSE CHECK

$$383 - 147 = 236 \quad \text{Correct}$$

Why checking matters beyond school

This habit helps pupils notice an incorrect receipt, question an unexpected total and verify a measurement before a mistake becomes costly. It builds independence as well as accuracy.

By the end of this topic, pupils should be able to:

- add and subtract ones, tens and hundreds mentally
- use columnar methods with numbers up to three digits
- estimate an answer before calculating
- use inverse operations to check an answer
- solve missing-number and practical problems
- explain why a chosen method is efficient

CORE IDEA

Choose an efficient method, estimate the result and always check that it is sensible.